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Bazaar

GIGABYTE GTX 1060 G1 Gaming

NVIDIA's answer to the AMD RX 480

NVIDIA has probably been sweating hard every since the AMD RX 480 came out to conquer the mid-range segment so it was only a matter of time for the GeForce GTX 1060 to make an appearance and it's finally here to give AMD's RX 480 a good fight. Priced at ₹22,999 the NVIDIA GeForce GTX 1060 is no longer hitting the sweet spot in India, but it is priced to combat the AMD RX 480. The GIGABYTE GTX 1060 G1 GAMING graphics card is priced at an Indian MSRP of ₹25,499.

The GP106 is a scaled down version of the GP104 that powers the GTX 1080 and the GTX 1070. And just like the GTX 960, where the GM206 was half of the GM204, with the GTX 1060 the GP106 seems to be exactly half of a GP104 as well. So we're getting 2 GPCs with 5 Pascal SMs in each GPC. Given that there are 128 CUDA cores within each SM, in total we are getting 1280 CUDA cores, 80 Texture units and 48 ROPs. There are six 32-bit memory controllers with eight ROPs per controller and all six controllers combine to provide a net bandwidth of 192 GB/s.

As for the memory, the GTX 1060 comes with 6 GB of GDDR5 VRAM. While this may be a little less than the 8 GB RX 480, it is priced to compete with the 4 GB RX 480 SKU, thus giving NVIDIA a slight advantage. The GIGABYTE GTX 1060 G1 Gaming graphics card comes with a factory over-clock of 1595 MHz going all the way to 1810 MHz under boost. We did notice it go all the way to 1999 MHz while running Unigine Heaven 4.0. This extra juice is thanks to GPU Boost 3.0.

The GIGABYTE GTX 1060 G1 Gaming features GIGABYTE's WINDFORCE cooling solution and in particular the WINDFORCE 2X because the solution has two fans. Each 90 mm fan has protruding streaks to cut down on noise levels. Moreover, like all cards featuring Maxwell and Pascal architecture, these fans only switch on when the temperatures hit 60 degrees Celsius. While the cards are silent till it hits this threshold, the sudden ramp up generates a noticeable sound.

The GIGABYTE GTX 1060 G1 Gaming is a dual-slot graphics card. Dual-slot cards were essential towards ensuring an easy SLI configuration but since the GTX 1060 does not feature SLI, we can only look at this as a space saving design decision. The GIGABYTE GTX 1060 G1 Gaming uses an 8-pin PCIe power connector giving it a plenty of



Price
₹25,499
(+Tax)

headroom to seek power should it require so. One difference that the GIGABYTE SKU differs from the Founders Edition is that it has an 8-pin connector instead of a 6-pin connector. And lastly, we have the aluminium backplate which covers the entire card.

Performance

The GIGABYTE GTX 1060 G1 Gaming clearly is better than the AMD RX 480 which scored 2691 points in FireStrike Ultra and 5201 points in Fire Strike Extreme. Time Spy is 3DMark's latest DirectX 12 benchmark and the scores peg the RX 480 to be neck and neck with the GTX 1060. The GIGABYTE GTX 1060 G1 Gaming seems to be the better performer in Rise of the Tomb Raider and Shadow of Mordor as well. But DOOM is a completely different story with the NVIDIA GTX 1060. We noticed hardly any difference while switching between APIs on the GTX 1060. While with the RX 480, there was a tremendous 35 per cent performance difference. Between the two, the AMD RX 480 was the better performer across all screens except on 4K resolution with the OpenGL API.

Verdict

The GIGABYTE GTX 1060 G1 Gaming has more memory than the RX 480 for the price (unless you have a unit that can be flashed to get the full 8 GB) and it performs slightly better than the RX 480 in pretty much most games. The RX 480, however, makes the best use of Vulkan API and DOOM runs much better on the AMD RX 480 with the GTX 1060 gaining a minor lead at 4K resolution using OpenGL. This holds true if the cards are equally priced. One major loss with the GTX 1060 is the lack of SLI.

Mithun Mobandas



Performance..... 73
Build 75
Value for Money 65

Specifications

GTX 1060; CUDA Cores: 1280; Texture Units: 80; ROPs: 48; Core Clock: 1506 MHz; Boost Clock: 1708 Mhz; Memory Clock: 7Gbps GDDR5; Memory Bus Width: 192-bit; VRAM: 6 GB; TDP: 120 W

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